



SAVED HASSIB/REUTERS

Kabul Hit by Deadly Pakistani Strike
Afghanistan vowed to retaliate after an attack on a drug rehabilitation center killed dozens in the nations’ escalating conflict. Page A4.

In Alabama, the Right Vilifies an Islamic School

By ROBERT DRAPER
BIRMINGHAM, Ala. — In seventh-grade history, the topic was Hannibal’s invasion of Italy. In science class, a teacher dropped a chalkboard eraser to demonstrate the gravitational potential of energy. Down the hall, 16 third graders fielded questions about dhikr, a form of Islamic worship using repeated phrases to glorify God.
The school, the Islamic Academy of Alabama, has occupied the same small cinder block building in the Birmingham suburb of Homewood for the past three decades. It is considered one of the state’s highest-performing K-12 institutions, with graduation and college acceptance rates close to 100 percent. Located on the same campus where a school for Black children was burned down twice in the 1930s by the Ku Klux Klan, it had long gone without attracting controversy. Until last summer, that is, when school officials found a larger building to house its 270 students, in an office park in the nearby community of Hoover.
“The response was, ‘I didn’t even know these people are here, and now they need a bigger building?’” said Bryan Dawson, a Birmingham right-wing podcast host and chief executive of the Alabama outlet 1819 News. “That’s the alarm that went off in Hoover.” Mr. Dawson helped lead a grass roots campaign against the building, and late last year Hoover city officials voted against the school’s relocation.
Continued on Page A14

Academy Seeks Larger Building but Finds Vitriol Instead

Tech’s Big Bet On Weapons Is Paying Off

By SHEERA FRENKEL
SAN FRANCISCO — As the third week of the war in the Middle East continues, intelligence gathered by the Pentagon is being analyzed by technology from the artificial intelligence company Anthropic, on a system run by the data analytics firm Palantir.
Drones created by a defense tech start-up in Arizona have emerged as a key piece of the U.S. war arsenal.
And anti-drone systems made by a California start-up have been deployed to protect U.S. forces in the region.
Silicon Valley made risky bets in recent years on developing defense-related technology and providing services to the U.S. military establishment. Now those bets are paying off. From behemoths providing data systems to smaller companies offering novel weapons, tech firms such as Google, Palantir and OpenAI have found themselves at the heart of the U.S. war effort.
Their central role amounts to an “I told you so” moment. For years, the tech industry’s efforts on defense-related offerings faced skepticism and opposition, with no clear or immediate business rewards. Many Silicon Valley engineers opposed the use of powerful technologies for killing, battles and other military purposes — concerns that persist.
Despite those fears, venture capital firms have poured billions of dollars since the 2010s into start-ups building drones, lasers and other military systems. In
Continued on Page A9



EMILY KASK FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

When a Sham Rocked the Internet
Twenty years later, the legend of a leprechaun sighting has left its mark on Mobile, Ala. Page A18.

Trapped in the Back When Robot-Haters Attack

By ERIN GRIFFITH
SAN FRANCISCO — In January, Doug Fulop was riding home from a night out in San Francisco when a man crossed the street in front of his car, doubled back and began screaming at him. The man punched the windows and tried lifting up the vehicle. He yelled that he wanted to kill Mr. Fulop and the other two passengers for giving money to a robot.
A taxi driver would have simply driven away. But Mr. Fulop’s vehicle had no driver — it was a self-driving Waymo.
“We felt helpless,” said Mr. Fulop, 37, who works in the tech industry.
Since autonomous cars started roaming San Francisco four years ago, they have elicited an array of reactions from humans, including angry protests against the vehicles. That has created an unexpected hazard for passengers of self-driving cars all around the city: being stuck inside the vehicle during an anti-robot rant.
Self-driving cars are designed to stop moving if a person is
Continued on Page A19

Driverless Taxis Do Not Run From Rage

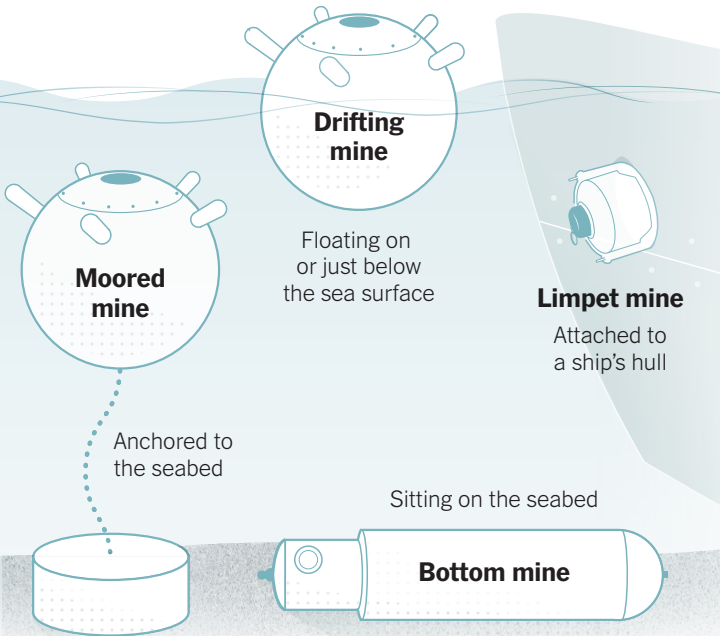
Trump’s Shifts on Iran Threatening Globe

By ZOLAN KANNO-YOUNGS
President Trump dismissed the value of allies in his war in Iran on Monday. And then he demanded their help.
“We don’t need anybody,” he said, echoing a refrain he has sounded since the beginning of the war. But, he added, other nations must take up the task of securing the Strait of Hormuz, whose near-closure by the Iranian
Continued on Page A9

NEWS ANALYSIS

ans is hobbling the global oil supply.
His remarks were the latest in a string of dizzying turnabouts in Mr. Trump’s positions on the war, sometimes issued in nearly the same breath. He has called it just an “excursion” but also a critically important means of addressing an existential threat. He
Continued on Page A9

Waiting in the Waves
Some maritime mines float on the surface. Some rest on the seafloor. All could complicate efforts to restart shipping in the Persian Gulf. Page A6.



Note: Not to scale. Sources: CAT-UXO; RAND. SAMUEL GRANADOS/THE NEW YORK TIMES



BUSINESS B1-6
U.S. Pursuit of Rare Earths
The Export-Import Bank is providing a \$10 billion loan to an initiative to stockpile critical minerals. *PAGE B1*

Undeterred by Higher Fares
Airline executives said the war in Iran had raised fuel costs, but that had not yet hurt demand for tickets. *PAGE B1*

NATIONAL A11-19, 24
Easing Life After Prison
Medicaid is now paying for health care in prisons, smoothing inmates’ return to the community. Law enforcement officials say they’re all for it. *PAGE A11*

Senate Takes Voter I.D. Bill
Under relentless pressure from the president, Republican lawmakers narrowly agreed to open debate. *PAGE A13*

INTERNATIONAL A4-10
Next Up for U.S.: ‘Taking Cuba’
At war with Iran and in control in Venezuela, the president is signaling a new intervention. News Analysis. *PAGE A5*



ARTS C1-6
Making a Fresh Start
Grace Ives’s 2022 album, “Janky Star,” won her accolades, but she didn’t begin a follow-up until she got sober. *PAGE C1*

Italy Inspires U.S. Artist
What Mark Rothko saw on trips to Florence molded his vision and his understanding of space and color. *PAGE C1*

SPORTS B7-10
Last Pitch at Umpire Academy
The Harry Wendelstedt school, the last independently run operation recognized by Major League Baseball, has closed as robo umps and other advancements usher in a new era. *PAGE B7*

Ways to Build on Success
Organizers of the Winter Paralympics, which set attendance and viewership records at the Milan-Cortina Games, are assessing how to grow while maintaining high standards. *PAGE B10*

OPINION A22-23
The Editorial Board *PAGE A22*



FOOD D1-8
Rotisserie Chicken Done Right
The dish has become a Canadian classic mentioned alongside poutine, smoked meat and bagels. Above, the rotisserie at Rôtisserie La Lune in Montreal. *PAGE D1*

